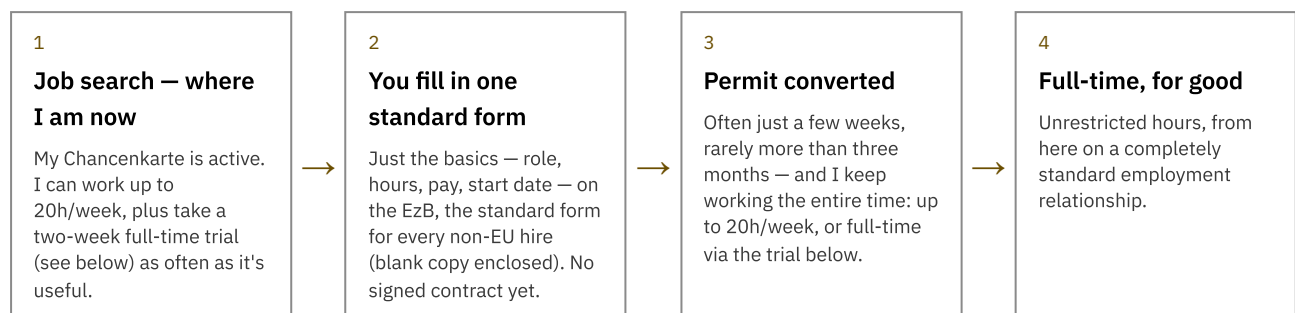


Work authorization

What the 20-hour limit really means for me — and the trial that removes the risk

You may have seen that my Chancenkarte limits me to 20 hours of work a week and wondered whether I could take on a full-time role. That limit — and the two-week trial option below — only applies while I'm still job-hunting. Under German law (§18 Abs. 2 AufenthG), a concrete job offer is enough to start converting my permit to full, unrestricted work authorization — I don't need a signed contract in hand yet. No sponsorship or visa procedure needed from you at any point.

HOW I GET TO FULL-TIME



TRY ME BEFORE YOU COMMIT

A risk-free, two-week full-time trial (Probefbeschäftigung)

My Chancenkarte already lets me work full-time for up to two weeks at a stretch, as many times as useful, alongside other steps. No change to my permit, no paperwork on your side — just my normal pay for those two weeks (it's a genuine employment relationship under §611a BGB, not unpaid work), and a straightforward way to see how I work before deciding to hire me.

SOURCES

- § 20a AufenthG – Chancenkarte – https://www.gesetze-im-internet.de/aufenthg_2004/__20a.html
- § 18 Abs. 2 AufenthG – concrete job offer requirement – https://www.gesetze-im-internet.de/aufenthg_2004/__18.html
- § 611a BGB – employment contract, pay obligation – https://www.gesetze-im-internet.de/bgb/__611a.html
- Erklärung zum Beschäftigungsverhältnis (EzB), Bundesagentur für Arbeit – https://www.arbeitsagentur.de/datei/erklaerung-zum-beschaefligungsverhaeltnis_ba047549.pdf
- Make it in Germany – Employing Chancenkarte holders – <https://www.make-it-in-germany.com/en/companies/entry/employing-chancenkarte-holders>

Enclosed with my application, current as of August 2026 (§§18, 20a AufenthG, §611a BGB) – for orientation, not legal advice.